

After the interview. What to do in the next 24 hours.

Thank you notes that don't sound like templates. How to follow up when you don't hear back. What to do after a rejection. When to stop following up.

IF YOU TAKE NOTHING ELSE AWAY

Five things that matter most

- Send a thank you note within 24 hours. Specific to the conversation. Under four sentences.
- Generic thank you notes are ignored. Notes that reference something specific from the interview are remembered.
- One follow-up after the stated timeline passes is professional. A second is acceptable. A third signals poor judgment.
- After a rejection, a brief and gracious response keeps the relationship alive for the next role.
- Never send a follow-up note longer than three sentences. If it takes longer, it's too long.

Most candidates send nothing after an interview. Some send a generic "thank you for your time" email. A small number send specific, human notes that actually get read. The difference shows.

THE THANK YOU NOTE

Specific beats grateful

Four sentences maximum. Reference one specific thing from the conversation. Confirm your interest in one sentence. That's all.

TEMPLATE: STANDARD THANK YOU NOTE

"[Name] — Our conversation about [specific topic from the interview] has stayed with me. [One sentence about why it resonated or what it clarified for you.] I'm genuinely interested in the role and the team — the [specific thing they mentioned] is exactly the kind of problem I'd want to work on. I look forward to next steps."

Send within 24 hours. Send to every person you interviewed with — each one personalized to something from your conversation with them specifically.

TEMPLATE: WHEN YOU WANT TO ADD SOMETHING YOU FORGOT TO MENTION

"[Name] — Thank you for the conversation. Something I didn't mention that feels relevant: [one specific thing, briefly]. Otherwise, I'm genuinely interested in the role and looking forward to hearing next steps."

Use sparingly — only when the thing you forgot is genuinely significant. Don't use this to reargue your candidacy.

NEXTCAPTER TOOL

After you log an interview in NextChapter, Victoria asks what came up in the conversation and generates a personalized thank you note in your voice — in under 2 minutes.

FOLLOWING UP ON SILENCE

One follow-up per stage. Then move on.

If they gave a timeline and it has passed

Follow up the day after the stated timeline. One sentence: "I wanted to follow up — I'm still very interested and happy to answer any additional questions if helpful." That's it. Don't add a paragraph about why you're a good fit.

If no timeline was given

Wait seven business days after the interview. Then one follow-up. After that: one more follow-up at two weeks. After that: move on. Do not follow up a fourth time.

FOLLOW-UP MESSAGE

"[Name] — I wanted to follow up on our conversation from [date]. I'm still very interested in the role and happy to provide any additional information that would be helpful."

Three sentences maximum. Never use the word "just" ("I just wanted to follow up") — it's apologetic and weakens the message.

AFTER A REJECTION

How you respond matters

A gracious response to a rejection keeps the relationship alive for the next opening — which often comes faster than expected. A bitter or over-explanatory response closes it permanently.

REJECTION RESPONSE

"[Name] — Thank you for letting me know. I enjoyed the process and the conversation with your team. If another relevant role comes up, I hope you'll keep me in mind — and I'm happy to be a resource if I can be helpful to you or your network in the meantime."

Then ask: "If you're open to it, I'd genuinely welcome a few minutes to understand what tipped the decision. Even a general sense would help me calibrate." This is optional — but often gets you more feedback than you'd expect.